

directions to the nearest restaurants or medical shops, and also pinpoint your exact location on a street map. Now if that's not nifty, what is?

Google Mobile

Expect Google to get into anything that has to do with the Internet! And if the Internet gets onto the mobile, Google *would* follow suit and develop applications for your cell phone. Their latest offering is called Google Local for mobile. This application lets the user search for locations and then view them on a map. Sounds a bit like GPS, doesn't it? But Google also lets you type in text searches, and the maps developed by Google are downloaded from a server and not pre-loaded onto your mobile.



Google mobile helps in local searches

Users can also view the location as a satellite image and get driving directions. Also, when a user finds a listing through the service, they can click on the phone number next to the listing, and voilà, your mobile phone finally acts like a phone.

Much like Google Maps and Google Earth users, those who use Google Local on the mobile can shift their view of the map or zoom in or out. The service is now available in the US, and most mobile service providers offer support for it. Apart from this service, the company also has a slew of offerings for the mobile customer. You can send text messages to Google asking them for directions and addresses, and WAP-enabled mobiles can (obviously) access the mobile version of Google search. Although most of these services are available only in the US and other developed countries, it's only a matter of time before the company launches similar services in India.

TV On Mobile

Imagine catching the latest episode of your favourite serial on your